

Smartbands

We scour the wearable landscape in India and compare some of the top wristbands

Bazaar

All the latest and greatest products tested and reviewed so you make an informed buying decision

LAPTOPS ON A BUDGET



When you have around 40k to spend on a laptop, which one do you go with? We test laptops from Acer, ASUS, HP, and Lenovo to tell you just that...

Jayesh Shinde
jayesh.shinde@9dot9.in

Somewhere around the middle of every calendar year, laptops start getting refreshed to newer platforms, and manufacturers start rolling them out for consumers to purchase. It's also the time when students and young professionals are buying laptops, based on the flurry of emails asking us for laptop recommendations under 30k and 40k. Through this feature, we aim to address most of your concerns, dear reader,

and give you some compelling options to consider for your next budget laptop spend.

It's good to see Intel's 5th generation Core i3 processors being available on laptops selling under the 40k mark, something that we saw on a couple of laptop brands in this comparison. The latest iteration of Intel chipset is good for boosting the laptop's battery life more than anything else, and good to see those SKUs available at an affordable price point. We also received an AMD-powered laptop for review after a long long time,

because we always wondered how good are AMD's APU compared to low-powered Intel Core i3 units. No need to wonder anymore, as you'll see the result for yourself in the mag table of this comparison. Other trends seen in this comparison are the fact that 4GB of RAM and 1TB of hard drive has become pretty much the defacto for laptops selling over 30k, which is a great revelation. Also, almost laptops we tested here come with some sort of cloud data solution (either by partnering with Microsoft OneDrive or their own propri-

etary service), and this is a great value add for consumers.

We received laptops from most leading brands in the market, especially given the price restriction we had placed on them when we requested for review units. Acer, ASUS, HP and Lenovo wasted no time in getting units to us. We received 12 units in total, but had to drop machines from Acer, ASUS and Lenovo for either not fitting the criteria (price-wise) or malfunctioning during the process of our testing. We tried very hard to secure a Dell budget laptop to feature in this comparative